

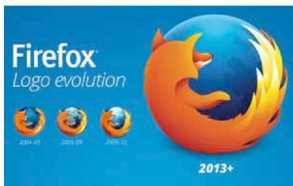
Firefox 23 released

Mozilla recently launched Firefox 23 for Windows, Mac, Linux and Android. The new version includes improvements like the addition of a share button, a mixed content blocker, a network monitor and a new logo along with minor tweaks.

The new desktop version of Firefox 23 is available for download on Firefox.com and existing users should be able to upgrade to it automatically. Together with the desktop version, its Android version is also available on Google Play.

One of the most significant additions to the browser is undoubtedly its new share button and panel for the browser's social API. In short, users can now share content directly from Firefox, with their friends on social networks with a single click, regardless of where they are.

Another improvement is the all-new mixed content blocker. This prevents non-secure (HTTP) content on a website from being read or modified by attackers, by blocking it from being compromised. Mixed content refers to a Web page containing a combination of both secure (HTTPS) and non-secure (HTTP) content delivered to the browser on a secure data channel.



OpenOffice 4.0 released

The Apache Software Foundation (ASF) has released the latest version of its open source office suite, OpenOffice 4.0. Although LibreOffice



has left OpenOffice way behind in terms of popularity, both the office suites are available on different platforms including Windows, Linux and OS X. However, none of them have been able to deliver the long-promised option of software-as-a-service (SaaS) as a cloud version. The new OpenOffice offers improvements in the user interface and in interoperability with Microsoft Office. Users will also experience enhanced graphics support and many other noticeable changes with OpenOffice 4.0. The most significant feature that comes with this version is Microsoft Office Open XML (OOXML) support.

The new OpenOffice also comes with support for docx outline levels, table background colours from table styles, increased number of bullets and numbering support, and support for font colours in pptx files.

An Android-based robot reaches the International Space Station!

In August, Japan launched a cargo-carrying rocket, which was loaded with supplies meant for the crew of the International Space Station (ISS). The most interesting part was that the cargo also carried a small robot, which is to be a companion to the astronauts on the ISS.

The small robot that can 'speak' is the first Android object to travel into space

National Repository of Open Education Resources launched

The HRD minister, M M Pallam Raju, recently launched the National Repository of Open Education Resources (NROER), while inaugurating the conference on 'ICT for School Education' in New Delhi. This step by the Central government will also give a fillip to the open source movement in India.

Also present on the occasion was minister of state for HRD, Shashi Tharoor, who said that his ministry is continuously working towards inclusiveness in education. The use of ICT would be very crucial in making education inclusive. Although technology cannot replace the teacher, it will make teaching more attractive. Dr Tharoor said: "This initiative is also a significant step towards inclusive education. Opening access to all requires a debate on the issue of ownership, copyright, licensing and a balancing of reach with legitimate commercial interests. This is particularly important for public institutions and public funded projects. I am glad that the NCERT has taken the initiative of declaring that the NROER will carry the CC-BY-SA licence... This decision by NCERT is in tune with UNESCO's Paris Declaration on Open Education Resources and will ensure that all the resources are freely accessible to all. To put it in the language of the Creative Commons — to reuse, revise, remix and redistribute."

Throwing light on the initiative, Ashok Thakur, secretary for Higher Education, said that the ICT initiative is not just about promoting schools, but teachers and students as well. He said that, at present, 400 universities and 20,000 colleges are being connected through ICT.